

achieve a 20 per cent market share with the launch of new Vaio models.

Garmin-Asus to capture 20 per cent of smartphone market

Garmin-Asus, a company that focuses on the integration of location-based services (LBS) technology in smartphones, aims to capture an impressive 20 per cent share of the Indian smartphone market.

With the high number of sales enquiries generated for the recently launched Garmin-Asus M10, ASUS is confident that Indian consumers are gradually making the transition from buying just lifestyle phones to phones that are an ideal choice to maintain balance in their hectic work-life schedule.

Efforts are also being made to fortify the relationship with channel partners through channel meets and tie-ups with global telecommunication giants like T-Mobile to ensure increased consumer awareness about the latest products and to enable ASUS to present an ever-increasing range of smartphones based on LBS technology.

Samsung to bring down smartphone price to Rs 10,000

Samsung is planning to take smartphones to the masses in order to drive its revenues. Expanding its smartphone portfolio, the company recently unveiled two new mobile handsets—Wave and Galaxy S—and announced plans to bring down the price of smartphones to Rs 10,000 by the year-end. While Wave has been launched on its own open mobile platform 'bada,' Galaxy S is the company's first smartphone based on Google's Android.

"We want to make smartphones available to a larger population and our new platform will aid that," said Ranjit Yadav, mobile and IT business, Samsung director.

Samsung aims to capture 20 per cent of India's market in the smartphone segment this year.



Samsung Galaxy Spica (I5700) Android-powered Smartphone

LG focuses on youth-centric phones

LG Electronics India has launched two new mobile handsets—Cookie Fresh and Cookie Plus—as part of its proposed launch of 44 handsets this year.

Sudhin Mathur, business head, mobile communication, LG Electronics India, said, "Our focus will be on youth-centric phones, which are expected to contribute 20 per cent to our value turnover. This translates to about Rs 6 billion. The current launches will contribute about 50 per cent to this category."

With 22 launches in the year till date, LG will introduce the rest in the remaining part of the year. The company will invest around Rs 2.9 billion this year on marketing. It expects to achieve revenue of Rs 30 billion from its mobile business as against Rs 10 billion last year.

Dell goes 'open'

Dell is all set to roll out its new range of products, mostly riding on open platforms like Chrome and Android. Said Amit Midha, president, Dell, Greater China and South Asia, "There are going to be unique innovations coming up in the marketplace in two-three years. With a new form of computing, we want to be on that forefront. With Chrome, Android or anything like that, we want to be one of the leaders."

Acer to expand retail footprint

Acer is all set to expand its reach in India through Acer Mall retail chain. Impressed by the market response to its outlets, it has decided to add 50 more retail outlets to its existing 250.

Talking exclusively to EFYTimes.com, S. Rajendran, chief marketing officer, Acer India, said, "We will take our retail network to other parts of the country by adding 50 more Acer Malls by the end of this year. The Acer Malls will be opened in B and C cities, where we see exponential demand for our products."

Acer is also planning to launch notebooks and netbooks in the 3G category.

MVL plans handset manufacturing plant

MVL Group, a property developer and consumer electronics maker, will soon join the league of mobile phone manufacturers in India. The company is reportedly planning to establish a manufacturing plant and a research unit to spearhead its foray into handsets business. It has earmarked Rs 4 billion to start manufacturing in India.

The privately owned group has also created MVL Telecom to manufacture and sell mobile handsets in the country under its own brand. It plans to roll out its products soon with the help of a strong sales network spread across top 20 cities of the country.

The company plans to introduce handsets in the range of Rs 1400 to Rs 5000.